

Economics Is Everywhere

Shorter 15-minute version for a fast, engaging talk

Economics in plain language

Real-life examples and humour

Strong ending on careers and value

0–5 min

What economics is

5–10 min

Real life + interesting fields

10–15 min

Why it matters + careers

Welcome

Hello everyone, and thank you for being here. Today I want to explain what economics is, why it matters in everyday life, and why it can be a smart subject to study.

What is economics?

Economics is the study of how people make choices when resources are limited. Time is limited, money is limited, and opportunities are limited. That means we all face trade-offs every day.

Economics in real life

Economics is in the coffee shop line, in concert tickets, in choosing a university program, and in weekly grocery shopping. Every choice has an opportunity cost, which means when we choose one thing, we give up something else.

Big issues today

Economics helps us understand inflation, jobs, housing, climate policy, and technology. It gives us a way to make sense of what is happening around us.

Amazing fields in economics

Behavioural economics studies why humans do not always act rationally. Neuroeconomics studies how the brain makes decisions. Other fields include labour economics, environmental economics, health economics, finance, and public policy.

Why study economics?

Economics builds strong skills in analysis, communication, data, and problem-solving. It is practical, flexible, and useful in many careers.

Careers and closing

Economics graduates can work in government, business, finance, consulting, research, and many other areas. Most of all, economics helps us ask better questions and make better decisions. Thank you.

A few light jokes to sprinkle in

- Behavioural economics begins with a simple thought: humans are not robots.
- We all plan to become disciplined tomorrow. Behavioural economics studies what happens when tomorrow arrives.